Good readers make predictions. A prediction is when you guess what might happen next. You think about what you already know about the characters and what has already happened in the story. Sometimes you will be right, sometimes you will be wrong. If you are wrong, you will make a new prediction and read on to see if you are right!

Clues from the story
+ what you already know
= prediction

Zach is celebrating his eleventh birthday. His friends arrive at his house; they play, and eat cake and ice cream. When they are done eating cake and ice cream, his parents start putting presents in front of him.

What do you think Zach will do next? open presents

Why do you think this? His parents put presents in front of him.

When Zach saw that it was a new baseball and glove he was so excited! "Now I can play catch with Greg anytime I want. I can't wait to tell him."

What do you think Zach will do next? call Greg

Why do you think this? He is very excited.

**Prediction**

*Read the information and trace the dotted words.*

Good readers make predictions. A prediction is when you guess what might happen next.

Clues from the story
+ what you already know
= prediction

Greg was very excited because Zach had invited him to go to the beach on Saturday. "I hope my parents will let me go. I'm supposed to clean my room on Saturday."

What do you think Greg will do next? Ask for permission to go to the beach.

Why do you think this? I know I have to ask permission before going somewhere.

Greg asked his parents and they told him he could go as long as his room was clean before Friday night.

What do you think Greg will do next? Clean his room

Why do you think this? I know if I want to go somewhere, I first have to do my jobs at home.

**Prediction**

*Read the information and trace the dotted words.*

Zach arrived at the ball field, got out of the car, and threw his batting bag over his shoulder. His team was in the outfield beginning to warm-up. He walked toward them.

What do you think will happen next? _____

Why do you think this? _____

_____

Greg watched Zach warm-up before the game. "My game doesn't start for another hour," he thought. The smell of fresh popped popcorn drifted in the air. Suddenly, his stomach began to growl.

What do you think will happen next? _____

Why do you think this? _____

_____

Zach was up to bat. Zach's team was losing by one run. There was a runner on third base creeping down the line toward home plate. The pitcher threw the ball and Zach bunted the ball towards first base.

What do you think will happen next?

Why do you think this? _____

**Prediction**

*Make predictions and explain your answer for the following paragraphs.*

Zach arrived at the ball field, got out of the car, and threw his batting bag over his shoulder. His team was in the outfield beginning to warm-up. He walked toward them.

What do you think will happen next? _____

**Zach will start to warm-up.**

Why do you think this? _____

**Everyone else on his team was warming-up.**

---

Greg watched Zach warm-up before the game. "My game doesn't start for another hour," he thought. The smell of fresh popped popcorn drifted in the air. Suddenly, his stomach began to growl.

What do you think will happen next? _____

**Greg will go get popcorn.**

Why do you think this? _____

**Greg is hungry and has time before his game starts.**

---

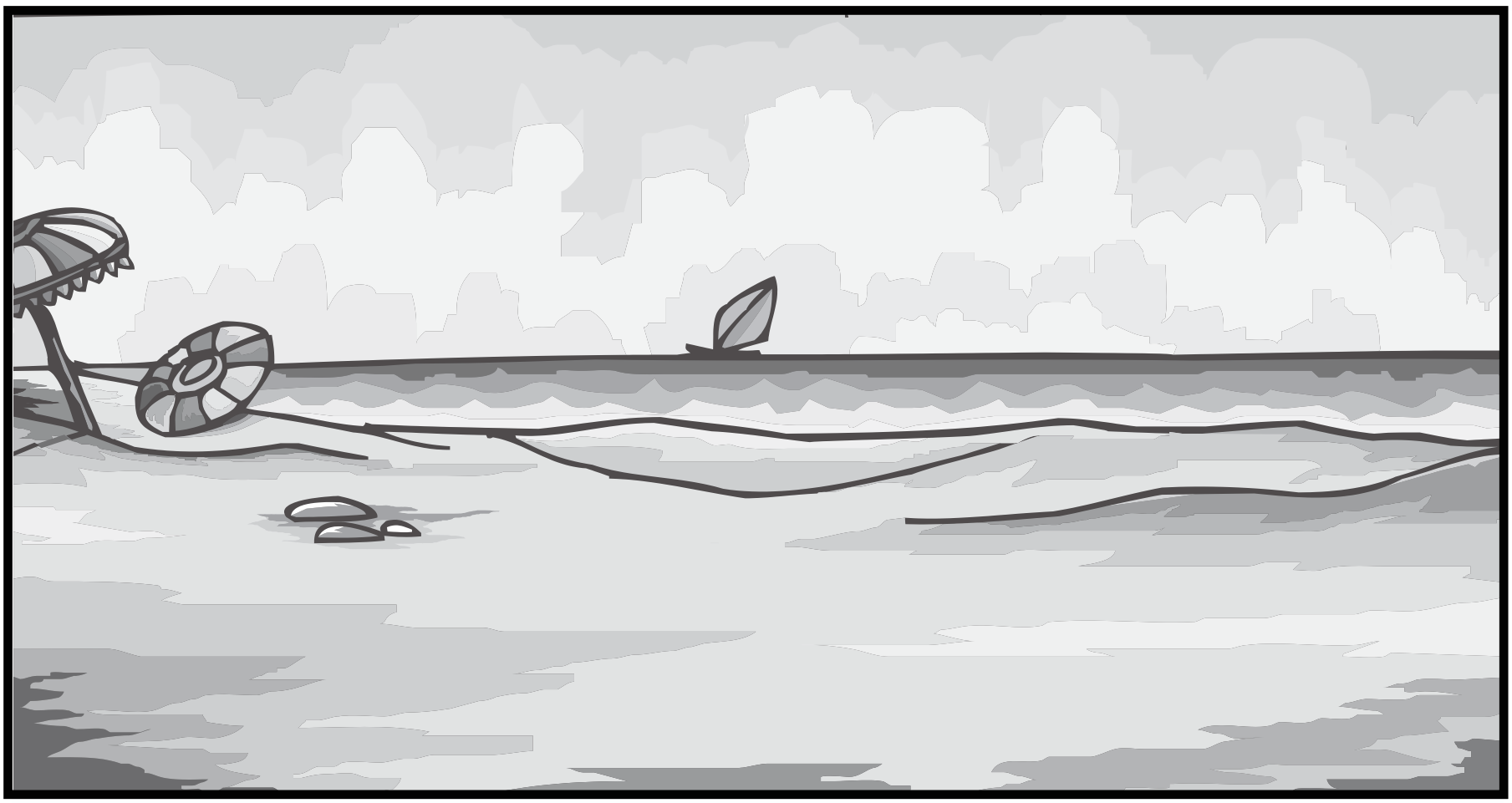
Zach was up to bat. Zach's team was losing by one run. There was a runner on third base creeping down the line toward home plate. The pitcher threw the ball and Zach bunted the ball towards first base.

What do you think will happen next?

**Zach will run to first base.**

Why do you think this? _____

**Zach is trying to score the person on third base.**



**Prediction**

*Draw what kind of sandcastle you think Greg and Zach will make at the beach.*

# Clues from the story
# + what you already know
# = prediction

Key words that are asking the reader for a prediction are:

**probably, likely, guess**

When you see these words, think about how the

**character** in the story **thinks** and **acts**.

Be careful!

1. Don't choose an answer that does not have clues in the story.
2. Don't be fooled by surprise answers that don't belong in the story.
3. Don't be fooled by answers that are the opposite of the clues.

Dusty was riding his bike and crashed on the sidewalk. When he tried to stand up, he saw he had a deep cut on his leg. When he got home, his mom saw the cut and cleaned it. She put him in the car to take him to the hospital.

What is **most likely** to happen next?

**X** The doctor will check to see if his arm is broken.

**X** They will be too busy to see him in the emergency room.

**X** Dusty will tell his mom he doesn't need to go and they stay at home.

✓ He will get stitches in his leg.

# Clues from the story
# + what you already know
# = prediction

Key words that are asking the reader for a prediction are:

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When you see these words, think about how the

character in the story thinks and acts.

Be careful!

1. Don't choose an answer that does not have clues in the story.
2. Don't be fooled by surprise answers that don't belong in the story.
3. Don't be fooled by answers that are the opposite of the clues.

Mariana and Michelle are good friends and were painting an Earth Day poster together. Mariana reached across the table to dip her paintbrush in the paint and she accidentally knocked over the cup that held the water. Water spilled across the table, dripped off its edge, and made a puddle on the ground.

What do you think Mariana will probably do next?

- **X** Michelle will be angry at Mariana.
- **X** Michelle will want to work with someone else.
- ✓ Together, the girls will clean up the water.
- **X** They will leave the water on the floor and use crayons.

1. The spider spun a web and sat quietly. A fly hovered and then landed on the web and was instantly caught on the sticky threads. What will probably happen next?

   - ◯ The fly will untangle himself and fly away.
   - ◯ The spider will quickly run and immobilize the fly.
   - ◯ The spider and the fly will fight each other.

2. Some mountains begin as volcanoes. Over millions of years, the sun, the wind, and the rain batter its surface. Slowly the face of the mountain becomes smooth and rounded. What will most likely happen in the future?

   - ◯ The volcano will erupt again.
   - ◯ The mountain will collapse.
   - ◯ The forces of nature will continue pounding the surface.

3. The community gathered at the vacant lot. They asked the city if they could rent the space. Soon after, several truckloads of soil were dropped off at the site. A load of vegetable and flower bedding plants was also delivered. What do you think will happen next?

   - ◯ The neighbors will plant a garden.
   - ◯ The neighbors will divide up the plants to take home.
   - ◯ The neighbors will pay someone to make flower beds.

**Prediction**

*Fill in the oval by the correct answer.*

1. The spider spun a web and sat quietly. A fly hovered and then landed on the web and was instantly caught on the sticky threads. What will probably happen next?

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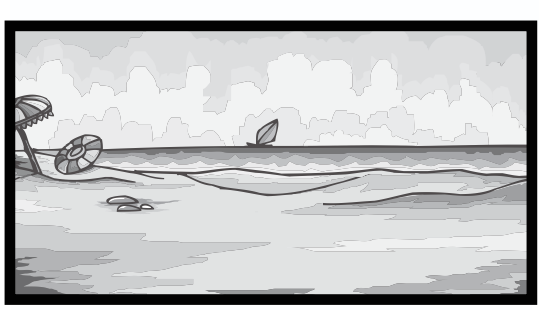

**Prediction**

*Draw a picture of what you think will happen next.*

Inference – Many times the author does not come right out and tell you what a character is going to do. You use details from the story about how a character acts or behaves plus what you know about life to make a good guess as to what is happening to the character in the story or how events may unfold.

Sir Arthur Conan Doyle wrote many books about a famous detective, Sherlock Holmes. Sherlock Holmes used clues left behind at a crime scene, things people told him, and his own experiences to solve crimes.

Use your detective skills to solve this crime.

The precious vase lay in pieces. The lovely tiger lilies now lay scattered in pools of water on the hardwood floor. Not a sound could be heard except for the slow roll of the basketball down the hall.

What happened?

Kids were playing with a basketball in the house and knocked over a vase, breaking it.

The author does not have to tell you kids were playing inside the house. You could figure that out from the clues the author left, and warnings your own parents have given you about the same kind of behavior. You might have even broken something yourself. This is an example of inference.

Details from the story about how a character acts or behaves plus what you already know helps you to make good guesses about the character or events in a story.

Use your detective skills to find out what will happen next.

Your classmates stand one behind the other. Some are jumpy, some are talking, and some are trying to look and see how much closer they have moved to the open door. The smell of chili hangs in the air. Your stomach starts to rumble and you glance at the clock. It is 12:15 p.m. Where are you?

Lunch line in the cafeteria

You are polishing the red truck and checking the instruments. Hoses have to be coiled so they are not tangled. Rescue gear is stowed in compartments in case of an emergency. Suddenly, an alarm goes off. You throw your rag onto the bench, step into your boots, and pull the heavy pants up. In one move you reach for both your hat and coat. Next, you jump into the truck and you are off!
What job do you have?

firefighter

1. Everyone has had one. They come in all shapes, colors, and sizes. Many of them have a bow tied around their neck. Some are cute and cuddly. Others are more realistic with their long snout and humped back. Many children sleep with one. It's told they are named after President Teddy Roosevelt. Which toy is it?

bear rabbit duck

2. Patches hunched down into the grass keeping her alert eyes on the tree overhead. As the squirrels bumped into each other, they ostled the bird feeder with its supply of seed. Some of the seed jostled to the ground. One squirrel, tired of fighting the rest, skittered down the tree and onto the grass. What will happen next?

the squirrel will eat the seed Patches will pounce

3. What is Patches?

a squirrel a child a cat

4. Shannon ran to the swing set and hopped on the nearest swing. Soon the other swings were filled with laughing children. After a few minutes, Shannon jumped off the swing and ran to the slide. It is likely Shannon is:

at lunch at recess in her backyard

**Inference** *Circle the correct answer.*

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   at lunch  at recess  in her backyard

It is cool and dark. The temperature never goes above 68 degrees even in the hottest of summers. You carry a flashlight because it is so dark. You enter the hole and start to move forward carefully. You hear a dripping noise and the floor is slick and bumpy. After about 10 feet, you hear a sound and stop. Suddenly, the flapping of wings and screeching is all around you even though you are ducking to avoid the flying mammals as they travel out into the evening air.

**Inference**

*Infer and draw the place described.*
*Put yourself in the picture.*

Like prediction questions, inference questions also use the key words:

probably, likely, guess

However, inference questions will ask about how a character acts or behaves. Inference questions may also ask about what is happening in an event in the story.

Prediction questions always ask what is going to happen next. Can you tell the difference? Trace the answer. Then trace what kind of question it is.

Rochelle slumped on the bench. The seconds were ticking away. The game would be over soon and her team would probably lose because she had struck out. Rochelle likely feels:

sad

What kind of question is this? inference

Rochelle couldn't believe it. The score was tied! They would play one more inning. She stood up, grabbed her hat, then her glove. What will likely happen next?

Rochelle will go play

What kind of question is this? prediction

Like prediction questions, inference questions also use the key words:

probably, likely, guess

Inference questions always ask about how a character acts or behaves, and possibly about the events in the story. Prediction questions always ask: what happens next?

Read the story, answer the question, and then tell what kind of question it is.

Orville and Wilbur had worked a long time on their project. Many people had laughed at them and said their idea was silly. Even though they owned a bicycle shop, they had a dream that people could fly and now they were ready to try out their flying machine. Wilbur stepped into the cockpit and adjusted his goggles. Wilbur probably felt: excited

What kind of question is this? inference

When Wilbur was settled in his seat, he turned the engine on. The chopping sound of the propeller seemed to surround him. Slowly the airplane rolled forward gaining speed. What will probably happen next? The airplane will take off.

What kind of question is this? prediction

1. The white paper was on the top of Nikki's desk. Her markers and crayons were in a box beside the paper. She remembered the teacher had told them to think of a special place. She remembered the warm sun, the white sand, and the boats floating in the water. What will Nikki probably do next?

draw a picture  write a story  read a book about boats

What kind of question is this?  inference  prediction

2. This was the kind of assignment Nikki loved best. She only wished she had those special markers she had at home, the ones that blended two colors into one. She thought of the possibilities and finally decided to cut some fish out of construction paper. Nikki is probably:

clumsy  creative  bored

What kind of question is this?  inference  prediction

3. When all the artwork was done, the teacher hung them outside the classroom while the students completed their spelling assignment. She stood back and admired the work. She thought the parents who came later would really like the work their children had done. She hoped most of the parents would be able to come to Open House. When is Open House most likely?

during school  at night  the next morning

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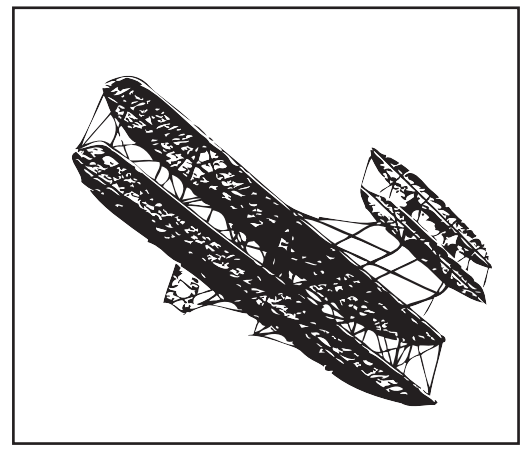

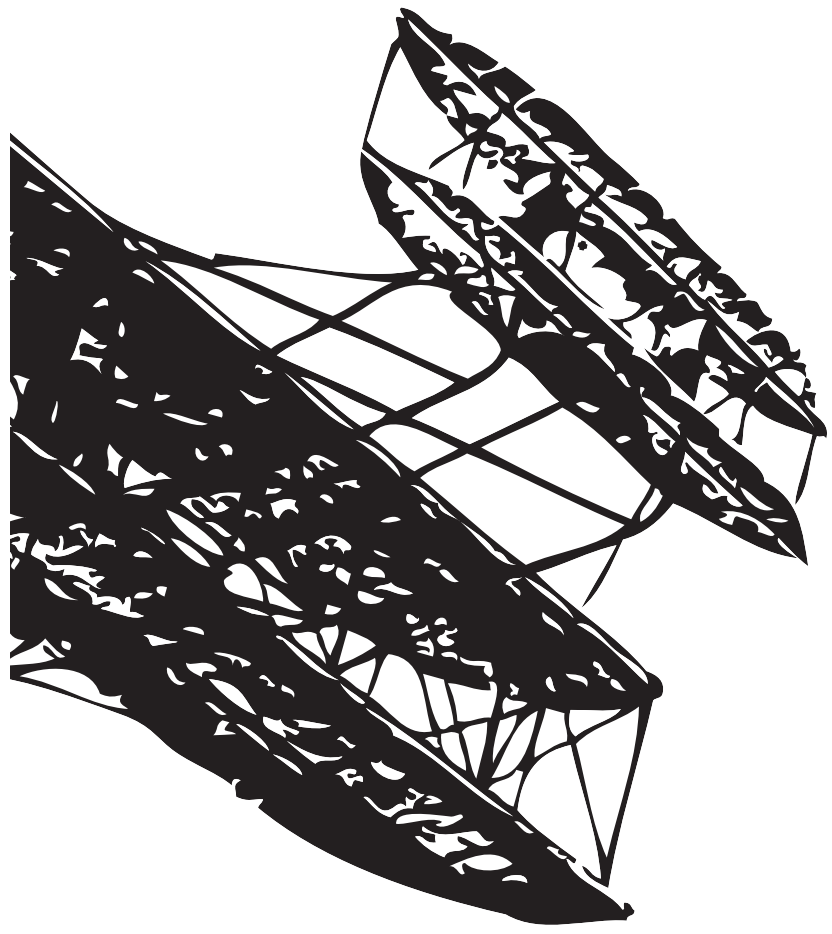

**Inference**

*Complete the picture of Wilbur and Orville's first plane.*

When you draw a conclusion, you take facts and details from the story and decide what it all means. The author will provide some information, but you will need to use your own knowledge to help you figure it out. Two questions to ask yourself are:

Is my conclusion based on what I read in the story?

Which of the clues from the story did I use?

Read the paragraph and circle the best headline.

Our school library is great! Our librarian holds special contests once a month to encourage us to read. We can choose from a wide assortment of books. The librarian helps us choose books we like. Sometimes we put on puppet shows for younger grade levels. Our library is a great place to be.

| VIDEOS AT THE LIBRARY | LIBRARY FUN | THE PUPPET SHOW |
|---|---|---|
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ | _____ |

Which newspaper story do you think the paragraph was taken from?

You should have chosen Headline 2 – Library Fun. The author is very excited about her library and enjoys going there.

Headline 1: Videos at the Library– no evidence of this.
Headline 3: The Puppet Show – this is only one small detail in the story.

In order to draw a conclusion about a story, you must:

Read the whole story so you understand it and think about the facts.

Your answer must be based on the facts.

Like prediction and inference questions, a question that asks you to draw a conclusion may use the same key words:

probably, likely, guess

After loading the trunk with a tent, sleeping bags, fishing poles, and groceries, Will and Stephanie jumped into the back seat. They could hardly wait. They started talking excitedly about what they would do when they got to Rainbow Falls. They talked about what they should do first. Stephanie suggested swimming, and Will suggested fishing. Either way, it was going to be a great weekend. They wished their parents would hurry up and get in the car.

Where are Will and Stephanie probably going? (Think of what they have in the car and how they could use those things.)

camping

What season is it? (Think of what they will be doing when they get to Rainbow Falls.)

summer

Hint: It may help to underline the important facts in the story.

Holly looked at her list: eggs, milk, and bread. She picked up the basket by the front door and put her umbrella in it. She was now walking up and down the aisles. She smiled at all the spooky decorations hanging from the ceiling. One by one, she found each of the items on her list. She walked by the candy aisle and her stomach growled. Too bad she didn't have any extra money.

1. What is Holly doing?

spending money  making French toast  grocery shopping

2. Why is she doing this?

she is hungry  she doesn't have those items  she needs to spend money

3. What is the weather probably like?

hot  cold  rainy

4. What time of the year is it?

fall  spring  summer

**Drawing Conclusions**

*Circle the BEST answer to the questions.*

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**Drawing Conclusions**

*Draw what you would like to buy at the grocery store.*

Prediction – asks the reader to figure out what is going to happen next.

Inference – asks the reader to make good guesses about how a character will act or behave.

Drawing conclusions - when the reader takes facts and details from the story to figure out what it all means.

All three of these skills require the reader to take facts and details from a story and causes them to think of things they already know to get the correct answer. The author will give the reader clues. It will be up to the reader to figure out what is happening.

All three may use these key words:

probably, likely, guess

**Review**

*Read the information and trace the dotted words.*

The day dawned cold and gray. We got up to get ready for school when our mom came in the room and said there was something on TV we would want to see. We followed her into the living room where the local morning news was broadcasting the weather. The only thing we heard were two incredible words - snow day! As the list of school closings was posted, our school was one of them, and smiles spread across our faces. This was going to be a great day!

1. What do you think will happen next?

The kids will go out and play.

2. Why was school cancelled?

The roads were closed and buses could not get through due to the snow.

3. Why did the children smile?

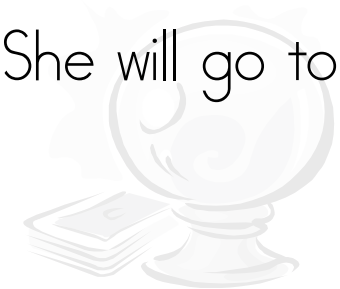
They were going to get to spend the day playing in the snow.

**Review**

*Read the information and trace the dotted words.*

Samantha laid in bed listening to the wind howl outside her window. The branches of the tree tapped against her window. She could hear the acorns falling onto the roof and the noise coming from the TV in her parent's room next door. She looked at her clock. It read 11:00. She should be asleep right now. She would be except she had just finished reading. This night was just like the Tuesday night described in Chapter Four, the one where the werewolf attacks the campers. Good thing she was inside, she decided. She glanced at the clock again, 11:20. This was going to be a long night.

1. What do you think will happen next?



She will go to sleep

She will turn on her lamp

2. How do you think Samantha will feel in the morning?

Scared

Foolish



3. Which of the following movies would Samantha probably like to see?

Don't Come Home After Dark

Valley Junior High

**Review**

*Circle the answer to the question and the symbol for the type of question.*

Samantha laid in bed listening to the wind howl outside her window. The branches of the tree tapped against her window. She could hear the acorns falling onto the roof and the noise coming from the TV in her parent's room next door. She looked at her clock. It read 11:00. She should be asleep right now. She would be except she had just finished reading. This night was just like the Tuesday night described in Chapter Four, the one where the werewolf attacks the campers. Good thing she was inside, she decided. She glanced at the clock again, 11:20. This was going to be a long night.

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**Review**

*Finish the picture to help you remember these important reading skills.*

Draw what you think Samantha looks like.

List synonyms for the word scared. How many can you think of?

If Samantha was talking to her best friend, what would she say?

Write about a time you were scared.

**Review**

*Fill in the graphic organizer below about Samantha from the previous story.*

A student falls asleep at his desk.

The Principal walked in the door.

A student runs up to a teacher at recess and says, "oh, no!"

Your best friend sees you and then starts to cry.

It is Monday morning, you roll over in bed, and look at the clock. It is 7:30, and you hear your bus stop in front of your house and beep the horn.

There is a knock at the door, and your dog starts to bark.

**Review**

*Draw or write what you think would probably happen next.*

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